

POC-07 - Azure Machine Learning

MLflow + LLMOps / MLOps

Beginner Reference Guide - End-to-End Implementation, Verification, Troubleshooting, Batch Deployment, and Cleanup

Synthetic shipment delay prediction with risk_score

Guide map

- 1. Objective, architecture, data contract and cost guardrails
- 2. Project structure and the role of each Python file
- 3. Poetry environment creation and complete local verification flow
- 4. Azure Portal: resource group and Azure Machine Learning workspace
- 5. .env, Azure CLI authentication, verify_config.py and connection checks
- 6. Register data, track two MLflow experiments, compare and register model
- 7. Local/Azure scoring and risk_score validation
- 8. Batch compute, endpoint, custom environment, deployment and invocation
- 9. Real errors encountered: auth mismatch, stale .env, batch child failure, image build failure
- 10. Final success evidence, cleanup, reproducibility and interview questions

Objective and production-minded architecture

- Predict whether a synthetic shipment will be delayed using eight leakage-reviewed features.
- Train two simple models: logistic regression baseline and random forest.
- Use local Python 3.12 for low-cost training, while Azure ML is used for tracking, data/model assets and optional batch serving.
- Log parameters, metrics, model, feature list, dataset fingerprint and code version through MLflow.
- Register the selected model, produce risk_score, then prove one batch scoring path works.
- Delete temporary endpoint and compute immediately after validation.

```
Local CSV -> local training -> MLflow tracking in Azure ML
                        -> compare candidates -> register selected model
                        -> local risk_score
                        -> optional Azure batch endpoint -> predictions
```

Cost guardrail: the final batch compute is scale-to-zero (min_instances=0, max_instances=1). Do not leave temporary serving resources running after the demo.

Data contract and leakage review

Training features are intentionally simple and explainable. The label is `is_delayed`. None of the input features should contain information only known after the shipment has already been delayed.

`origin_region`

`destination_region`

`carrier`

`distance_km`

`order_hour`

`weekday`

`priority`

`historical_delay_rate`

Leakage rule: do not add an outcome-derived field such as `actual_arrival_delay_minutes`, `final_delivery_status`, or a feature calculated after the prediction decision point.

Project structure - core files

```
POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT/  
  pyproject.toml      Poetry dependencies  
  poetry.toml         .venv inside project  
  .env                Azure workspace configuration  
  ml/  
    azure_utils.py    auth + MLClient helper  
    generate_data.py   synthetic train/scoring CSV  
    verify_config.py   Azure workspace + MLflow URI check  
    register_data.py   Azure ML data asset  
    train.py           LR + random forest + MLflow  
    compare_runs.py    compare candidates  
    register_model.py  register selected model  
    score.py           produce risk_score  
    verify_poc.py      final validation  
  tests/              deterministic data + feature contract
```

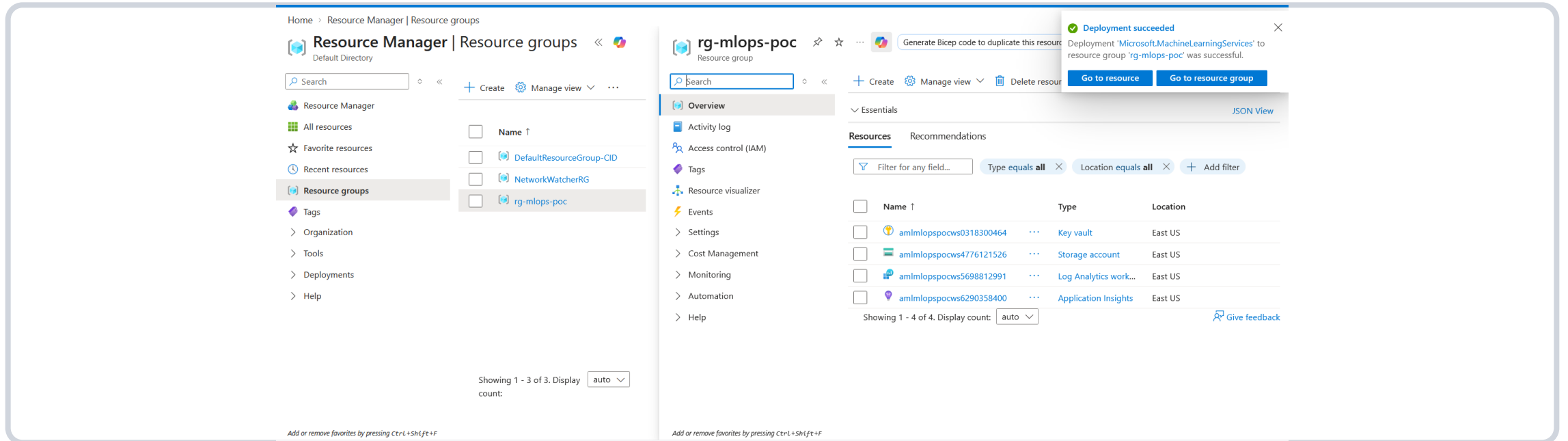
There is no smoke_test.py in the final POC-07 repository. Its role is covered by verify_config.py, verify_poc.py and pytest. This guide uses the actual final file names rather than inventing a script.

Project structure - Azure batch serving files

```
azure/batch/  
  deploy_batch.py  
  invoke_batch.py  
  cleanup_batch.py  
  environment/conda.yaml      explicit Python 3.11 serving env  
  code/batch_driver.py        explicit init()/run() batch scorer  
  
data/train/shipments.csv  
data/scoring/shipments_scoring.csv  
outputs/  
docs/  
.github/workflows/ci.yml
```

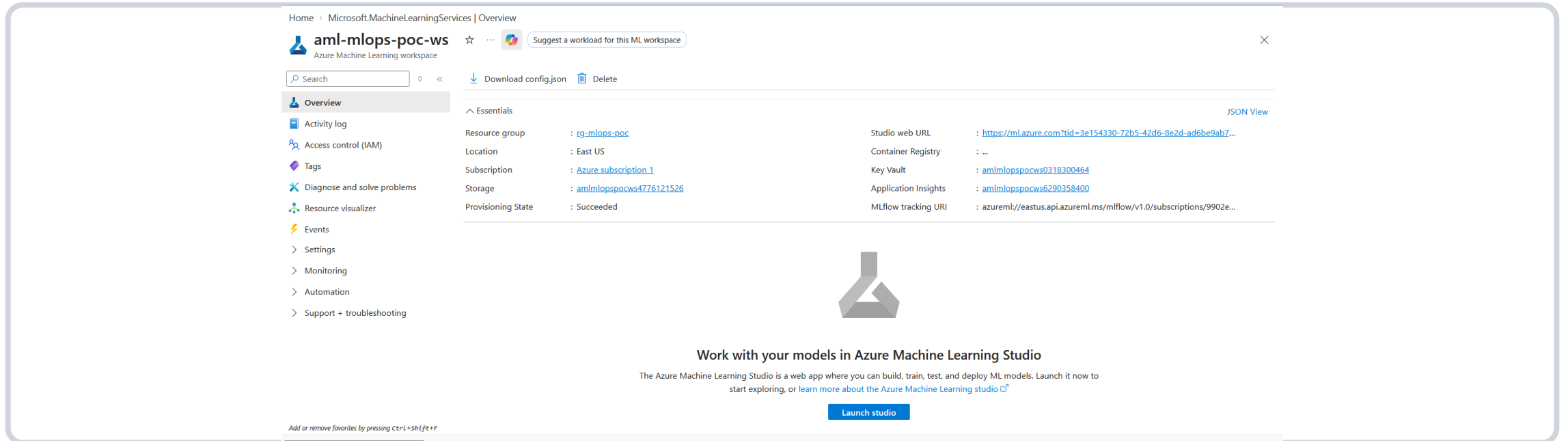
- `deploy_batch.py` creates/reuses scale-to-zero compute, endpoint, custom environment and fresh deployment.
- `invoke_batch.py` prepares an exact eight-feature CSV, invokes the deployment and downloads results.
- `cleanup_batch.py` removes endpoint and compute after validation.
- The remote scoring environment is intentionally separate from local Poetry/Python 3.12.

Create the Azure resource group



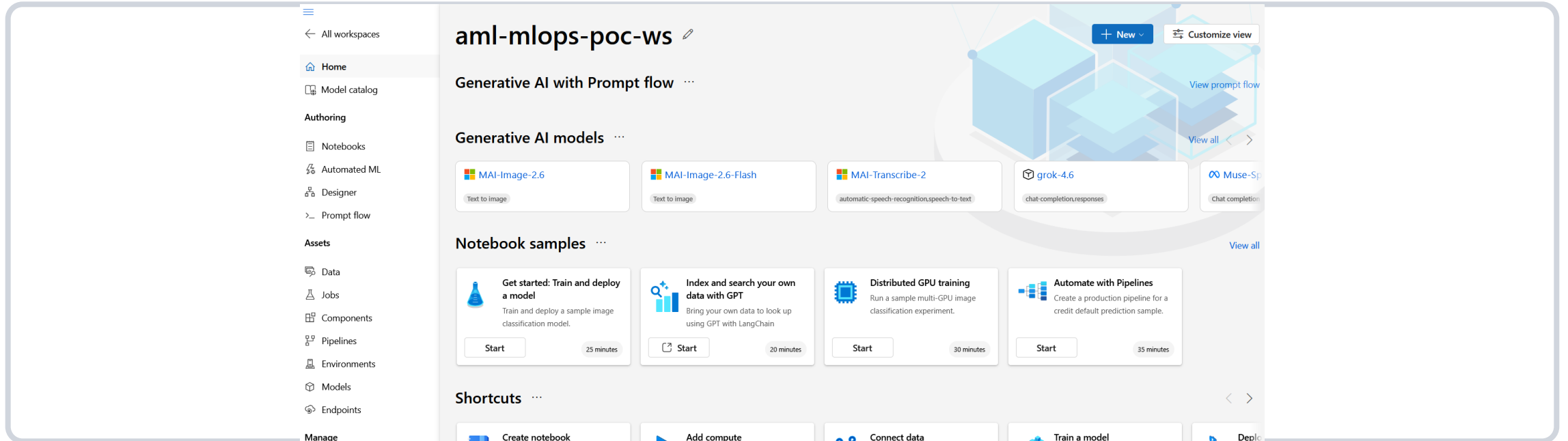
- Azure Portal -> Resource groups -> Create.
- Use one POC resource group so all resources can be deleted together later.
- Actual completed POC used resource group rg-mlops-poc.

Create the Azure Machine Learning workspace



- Azure Portal -> Create a resource -> Machine Learning -> Azure Machine Learning workspace.
- Choose the POC resource group and a supported region. The completed workspace name is aml-mlops-poc-ws.
- Wait until provisioning state is Succeeded.

Verify Azure ML workspace details



- Open the workspace and confirm subscription, resource group, region and provisioning state.
- Launch Azure ML Studio. The workspace provides access to Data, Jobs/Experiments, Models and Endpoints.

Create the Poetry environment

```
C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python --version
Python 3.12.11

C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -c "import mlflow, sklearn, pandas; p
rint('Poetry environment OK!)"
Poetry environment OK

C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.generate_data
[OK] Training data: C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\data\train\shipments.csv (2000 rows
)
[OK] Scoring data: C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\data\scoring\shipments_scoring.csv
(40 rows)
[INFO] Delay rate: 0.349

C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>call .venv\Scripts\activate.bat
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- Run the POC with Poetry instead of manually creating a pip-only venv.
- poetry.toml keeps the virtual environment inside the project at .venv.

```
poetry --version
py -3.12 --version
poetry env use 3.12
poetry install
poetry env info
poetry run python --version
```

Generate synthetic shipment data

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.generate_data
[OK] Training data: C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\data\train\shipments.csv (2000 rows)
[OK] Scoring data: C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\data\scoring\shipments_scoring.csv (40 rows)
[INFO] Delay rate: 0.349
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- Creates deterministic training data and a small scoring dataset.
- Expected outputs: data\train\shipments.csv and data\scoring\shipments_scoring.csv.

```
poetry run python -m ml.generate_data
```


Compare candidate models

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.compare_runs
MODEL COMPARISON
=====
model                roc_auc    f1  precision  recall  run_id
logistic_regression   0.6471    0.2456  0.6774    0.1500  e6be388928964bd69c
random_forest         0.6542    0.2584  0.6053    0.1643  532af7ecc057417bba
=====
Selected: random_forest (highest validation roc_auc; f1 used as tie-breaker)

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- Compare logged metrics and verify both candidate runs appear.
- Selection is based on validation ROC AUC with F1 used as tie-breaker.

```
poetry run python -m ml.compare_runs
```

Score locally and create risk_score

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.score --tracking local
[OK] Wrote 40 predictions: C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\outputs\predictions.csv
[INFO] Mean risk score=0.3580; mean latency=0.608 ms/row

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- Runs the selected local model against scoring rows.
- Outputs predictions.csv and scoring_metrics.json. risk_score is the estimated probability of delayed class 1.

```
poetry run python -m ml.score --tracking local
```

Run local validation and tests

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.verify_poc --tracking local
[PASS] Synthetic training data exists
[PASS] All required features and label exist
[PASS] Model selection manifest exists
[PASS] At least two MLflow runs were logged
[PASS] A selected run is recorded
[PASS] Feature list matches leakage-reviewed design
[PASS] A scoring path produced predictions
[PASS] risk_score is present
[PASS] risk_score is within [0, 1]
[PASS] Leakage review is documented

RESULT: PASS

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run pytest -q
.. [100%]
2 passed in 0.40s

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- Final local gate: verify required artifacts/runs and run automated tests.
- This is the POC-07 smoke-test equivalent.

```
poetry run python -m ml.verify_poc --tracking local
poetry run pytest -q
```

Generate data again before Azure flow

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.generate_data
[OK] Training data: C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\data\train\shipments.csv (2000 rows)
[OK] Scoring data: C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\data\scoring\shipments_scoring.csv (40 rows)
[INFO] Delay rate: 0.349
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- Re-run deterministic generation before publishing data to Azure so the dataset used in the cloud flow is known and reproducible.

```
poetry run python -m ml.generate_data
```


Configure .env for the Azure workspace

```
AZURE_SUBSCRIPTION_ID=<your-subscription-id>
AZURE_RESOURCE_GROUP=rg-mlops-poc
AZUREML_WORKSPACE_NAME=aml-mlops-poc-ws
AZUREML_WORKSPACE_NAME=aml-mlops-poc-ws
AZURE_AUTH_MODE=cli

MLFLOW_EXPERIMENT_NAME=poc07-shipment-delay
AZUREML_DATA_ASSET_NAME=shipment-delay-synthetic
AZUREML_MODEL_NAME=shipment-delay-model
AZUREML_BATCH_COMPUTE_NAME=cpu-poc07
AZUREML_BATCH_ENDPOINT_NAME=<unique-endpoint-name>
AZUREML_BATCH_DEPLOYMENT_NAME=blue-v2
AZUREML_BATCH_ENVIRONMENT_NAME=poc07-batch-mlflow-py311
```

Keep secrets out of Git. The local beginner flow uses Azure CLI authentication, so no client secret is required.

Error faced #1 - verify_config.py failed after browser authentication

```
(Poc-07-azure-ml-flow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermd\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.verify_config
[OK] Required .env settings are present.
C:\Users\ermd\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\msal\oauth2cli\oauth2.py:461: UserWarning: response_mode='form_post' is recommended for better security. See https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc9700.html#section-4.3.1
warnings.warn(
Traceback (most recent call last):
  File "<frozen module>", line 198, in _run_module_as_main
  File "<frozen runpy>", line 88, in _run_code
  File "C:\Users\ermd\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\ml\verify_config.py", line 36, in <module>
    main()
  File "C:\Users\ermd\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\ml\verify_config.py", line 27, in main
    ws = client.workspaces.get(client.workspace_name)
    ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
  File "C:\Users\ermd\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\azure\ai\ml\telemetry\activity.py", line 288, in wrapper
    return f(*args, **kwargs)
           ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
  File "C:\Users\ermd\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\azure\core\tracing\decorator.py", line 119, in wrapper_use_tracer
    return func(*args, **kwargs)
           ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
  File "C:\Users\ermd\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\azure\ai\ml\operations\_workspace_operations.py", line 143, in get
    return super().get(workspace_name=name, **kwargs)
           ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
  File "C:\Users\ermd\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\azure\ai\ml\operations\_workspace_operations_base.py", line 91, in get
    obj = self.operation.get(resource_group, workspace_name)
          ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
  File "C:\Users\ermd\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\azure\core\tracing\decorator.py", line 119, in wrapper_use_tracer
    return func(*args, **kwargs)
           ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^
  File "C:\Users\ermd\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\azure\ai\ml\_restclient\v2024_10_01_preview_tsp\operations\_operations.py", line 10022, in get_map_error(status_code=response_status_code, response=response, error_map=error_map)
    raise error
  File "C:\Users\ermd\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\azure\core\Exceptions.py", line 163, in map_error
    raise error
```

- Symptom: browser authentication completed, but workspace lookup still failed in Python.
- The workspace itself was valid; Azure CLI could find it. That isolated the issue to local credential selection/environment loading.
- Root cause in the original helper: `AZURE_AUTH_MODE=cli` did not actually select `AzureCliCredential`, and old environment variables could override the corrected `.env`.

Fix #1 - make CLI authentication explicit and reload .env correctly

```
# ml/azure_utils.py - corrected behavior
load_dotenv(dotenv_path=ENV_FILE, override=True)

if mode == "cli":
    return AzureCliCredential()
elif mode == "interactive":
    return InteractiveBrowserCredential(...)
else:
    return DefaultAzureCredential(...)
```

```
az login
az account set --subscription "Azure subscription 1"
az account show -o table
poetry run python -c "import ml.azure_utils as a; print(a.__file__)"
poetry run python -m ml.verify_config
```

Critical verification: verify_config.py should report Credential type: AzureCliCredential and Auth mode: cli. If a localhost browser still opens, you are running old code or an old imported module.

verify_config.py succeeds after authentication fix

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -c "import ml.azure_utils as a; print(a.__file__)"
C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\ml\azure_utils.py

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.verify_config
[OK] Required .env settings are present.

Effective configuration used by Python:
.env file      : C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.env
Subscription ID : 9902e04b...672c
Resource group  : rg-mlops-poc
Workspace       : aml-mlops-poc-ws
Tenant ID       : <Azure CLI/default>
Auth mode       : cli

[1/4] Building Azure credential...
[OK] Credential type: AzureCliCredential

[2/4] Testing Azure Resource Manager authentication...
[OK] Azure authentication succeeded.

[3/4] Looking up the configured Azure ML workspace...
[OK] Connected to Azure ML workspace: aml-mlops-poc-ws
[OK] Location: eastus
[OK] Resource group: rg-mlops-poc
[OK] Provisioning state: <not returned>

[4/4] Discovering Azure ML MLflow tracking URI...
[OK] MLflow tracking URI: azureml://eastus.api.azureml.ms/mlflow/v2.0/subscriptions/9902e04b-fd65-40f4-86a2-1b09c1fe672c/resourceGroups/rg-mlops-poc/providers/Microsoft.MachineLearningServices/workspaces/aml-mlops-poc-ws

[SUCCESS] Azure ML workspace + MLflow configuration verified.
Next: poetry run python -m ml.register_data

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- Python now reads the intended subscription, resource group and workspace values.
- Workspace lookup succeeds and the Azure ML MLflow tracking URI can be discovered.
- This is the gate before registering data or logging Azure MLflow experiments.

Register training data as an Azure ML data asset

```
[poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12] C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.generate_data
[OK] Training data: C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\data\train\shipments.csv (2000 rows)
[OK] Scoring data: C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\data\scoring\shipments_scoring.csv (40 rows)
[INFO] Delay rate: 0.349
[poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12] C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>|
```

- Registers/version-controls the synthetic training CSV in Azure ML workspace-managed storage.
- Use the data asset as the reproducible dataset reference recorded with the model.

```
poetry run python -m ml.register_data
```

Confirm the registered data asset

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.register_data
Uploading shipments.csv (< 1 MB): 100%|#####| 125k/125k [00:00<00:00, 158kB/s]

[OK] Registered data asset: shipment-delay-synthetic:4a779922364d
[INFO] Azure ML uploaded the local file to workspace-managed Azure Storage.

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- Open Azure ML Studio -> Data and verify the asset name/version.
- Registration confirms the local dataset has a cloud-visible lineage reference.

Track training runs in Azure ML through MLflow

- Logs two Azure MLflow runs using the workspace tracking URI.
- Each run records parameters, validation metrics, model artifact, feature list, dataset fingerprint and code version.

```
poetry run python -m ml.train --tracking azure
```

Verify experiment runs in Azure ML Studio

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.compare_runs
MODEL COMPARISON
=====
model          roc_auc    f1  precision    recall  run_id
logistic_regression  0.6471    0.2456    0.6774    0.1500  e4b89f55-c3c2-446b
random_forest      0.6542    0.2584    0.6053    0.1643  e7eebed1-712e-4219
=====
Selected: random_forest (highest validation roc_auc; f1 used as tie-breaker)
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- Open Jobs/Experiments and compare logistic regression vs random forest.
- Use the same selection rule as local validation.

```
poetry run python -m ml.compare_runs
```


Register the selected model

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.register_model --tracking azure
Successfully registered model 'shipment-delay-model'.
2026/09/06 17:30:13 INFO mlflow.store.model_registry.abstract_store: Waiting up to 300 seconds for model version to finish creation. Model name: shipment-delay-model, version 1
Created version '1' of model 'shipment-delay-model'.
[OK] Registered model: shipment-delay-model version 1
[OK] Registration manifest: C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\outputs\registered_model.json

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- Registers the chosen MLflow model into Azure ML model registry.
- Model metadata should retain metric, dataset reference, code version and limitations.

```
poetry run python -m ml.register_model --tracking azure
```

Verify the Azure ML registered model version

- Azure ML Studio -> Models -> shipment-delay-model.
- Confirm the registered version exists before attempting batch deployment.

Generate Azure-tracked risk scores

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python -m ml.verify_poc --tracking azure --check-registry
[PASS] Synthetic training data exists
[PASS] All required features and label exist
[PASS] Model selection manifest exists
[PASS] At least two MLflow runs were logged
[PASS] A selected run is recorded
[PASS] Feature list matches leakage-reviewed design
[PASS] A scoring path produced predictions
[PASS] risk_score is present
[PASS] risk_score is within [0, 1]
[PASS] Registration manifest exists
[PASS] Registered model version is queryable
[PASS] Leakage review is documented

RESULT: PASS

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- Produces risk_score and validates that the selected Azure-tracked model/registry artifacts are queryable.
- An AI agent may explain the prediction but must not claim causal certainty.

```
poetry run python -m ml.score --tracking azure
poetry run python -m ml.verify_poc --tracking azure --check-registry
```

Initial batch deployment succeeds, but invocation later fails

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python azure\batch\deploy_batch.py
[1/3] Creating/reusing scale-to-zero compute cpu-poc07 (Standard_DS2_v2)
[2/3] Creating/reusing batch endpoint shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c
[3/3] Deploying latest registered MLflow model shipment-delay-model
[OK] Batch deployment ready. Endpoint=shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c, deployment=blue

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

- deploy_batch.py created the compute/endpoint/deployment resource successfully.
- Important lesson: successful deployment resource creation does not prove the serving image can build or that the scoring child job will run.
- The first implementation relied too heavily on Azure inferring an MLflow serving environment.

```
poetry run python azure\batch\deploy_batch.py
```

Error faced #2 - invoke_batch.py parent pipeline fails

```
=====  
[2026-09-06 12:19:16Z] Submitting 1 runs, first five are: 2ef05055:dcbbed4f-c3d7-4cc2-b1dd-3f478374bfff3  
[2026-09-06 12:29:54Z] Execution of experiment failed, update experiment status and cancel running nodes.  
  
Execution Summary  
=====  
RunId: batchjob-65ffefa8-dc5f-49d7-8bae-da9451768198  
Web View: https://ml.azure.com/runs/batchjob-65ffefa8-dc5f-49d7-8bae-da9451768198?wsid=/subscriptions/9902e04b-fd65-40f4-86a2-1b09c1fe672c/resourcegroups/rg  
-mlops-poc/workspaces/aml-mlops-poc-ws  
Traceback (most recent call last):  
  File "C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\azure\batch\invoke_batch.py", line 37, in <module>  
    le>  
    main()  
  File "C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\azure\batch\invoke_batch.py", line 28, in main  
    client.jobs.stream(job.name)  
  File "C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\azure\core\tracing\decorator.py", line 119, in wrapper_use_tracer  
    return func(*args, **kwargs)  
    ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^  
  File "C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\azure\ai\ml\telemetry\activity.py", line 288, in wrapper  
    return f(*args, **kwargs)  
    ^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^^  
  File "C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\azure\ai\ml\operations\_job_operations.py", line 858, in stream  
    self._stream_logs_until_completion()  
  File "C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\.venv\Lib\site-packages\azure\ai\ml\operations\_job_ops_helper.py", line 334, in stream_logs_until_completion  
    raise JobException(  
azure.ai.ml.exceptions.JobException: Exception :  
{  
  "error": {  
    "code": "UserError",  
    "severity": null,  
    "message": "Pipeline has failed child jobs. For more details and logs, please go to the job detail page and check the child jobs.",  
    "messageFormat": "Pipeline has failed child jobs. {0}",  
    "messageParameters": {},  
    "referenceCode": "PipelineHasStepJobFailed",  
    "detailsUri": null,  
    "target": null,  
  },  
}
```

- Symptom: invoke_batch.py uploads input and submits a batch job, then client.jobs.stream() raises JobException.
- The parent error PipelineHasStepJobFailed is only a wrapper. The real failure must be diagnosed in the BatchScoring child job logs.
- Changing CSV columns alone cannot fix a failure that occurs before the scoring container starts.

Inspect the failed parent/child job instead of guessing

```
"name": "batchjob-65fffa8-dc5f-49d7-8bae-da9451768198",
"properties": {
  "azureml.continue_on_failed_optional_input": "False",
  "azureml.continue_on_step_failure": "False",
  "azureml.deploymentname": "blue",
  "azureml.endpointname": "shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c",
  "azureml.parameters": "{\r\n  \"run_max_try\": \"2\", \"run_invocation_timeout\": \"300\", \"mini_batch_size\": \"1\", \"error_threshold\": \"-1\", \"logging_level\": \"INFO\", \"process_count_per_node\": \"1\", \"NodeCount\": \"1\", \"append_row_file_name\": \"predictions.csv\"}",
  "azureml.pipelineComponent": "pipelinerun",
  "azureml.pipelineId": "efde2a32-4ba5-48e2-9935-f0c5c26dc933",
  "azureml.pipelines_stages": "{\r\n  \"Initialization\": null, \"Execution\": {\r\n    \"StartTime\": \"2026-09-06T12:19:15.835834+00:00\", \"EndTime\": \"2026-09-06T12:29:54.9564356+00:00\", \"Status\": \"Failed\"}}",
  "azureml.runsource": "azureml.PipelineRun",
  "runSource": "Unavailable",
  "runType": "HTTP"
},
"resourceGroup": "rg-mlops-poc",
"services": {
  "studio": {
    "endpoint": "https://ml.azure.com/runs/batchjob-65fffa8-dc5f-49d7-8bae-da9451768198?wsid=subscriptions/9902e04b-fd65-48f4-86a2-1b09c1fe672c/resourcegroups/rg-mlops-poc/workspaces/aml-mlops-poc-ws&tid=3e154330-72b5-42d6-8e2d-ad6be9ab706c",
    "type": "Studio"
  },
  "tracking": {
    "endpoint": "azureml://eastus.api.azureml.ms/mlflow/v1.0/subscriptions/9902e04b-fd65-48f4-86a2-1b09c1fe672c/resourcegroups/rg-mlops-poc/providers/Microsoft.MachineLearningServices/workspaces/aml-mlops-poc-ws?",
    "type": "Tracking"
  }
},
"status": "Failed",
"tags": {
  "azureml.batchrun": "true",
  "azureml.deploymentname": "blue",
  "azureml.jobtype": "azureml.batchjob",
  "inputType": "input_data",
  "outputType": "output_data"
},
"type": "pipeline"
}

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

```
az ml job list ^
--parent-job-name <PARENT_JOB_NAME> ^
--resource-group rg-mlops-poc ^
--workspace-name aml-mlops-poc-ws ^
--query "[].{Name:name,DisplayName:display_name,Status:status}" -o table
```

```
az ml job show --name <PARENT_JOB_NAME> ^
--resource-group rg-mlops-poc ^
--workspace-name aml-mlops-poc-ws --web
```

Root cause revealed - BatchScoring image build failed

The screenshot displays the Azure ML Studio interface. The left sidebar shows the navigation pane with 'Jobs' selected. The main workspace shows a pipeline diagram with a 'BatchScoring' node highlighted in red, indicating a failure. The right-hand pane shows the 'BatchScoring' job details. At the top, a red error message states: 'Image build failed. For more details, check log file azureml-logs/20_image_build_log.txt.' Below this, the 'Overview' tab is active, showing the job's status as 'Failed'. The 'Properties' section on the right lists the job's inputs, including 'job_data_path' and 'score_model', and provides the creation and start times. The 'Compute duration' is also visible at the bottom of the properties section.

- Azure ML Studio explicitly reports: Image build failed and points to azureml-logs/20_image_build_log.txt.
- This proves the model never reached CSV scoring. The environment/container image failed first.
- The failed job metadata still referenced the old deployment blue, timeout 300 and INFO logging - evidence that the invocation was still using the old serving deployment.

Fix #2 - use a fresh explicit batch serving environment

```
.env
AZUREML_BATCH_DEPLOYMENT_NAME=blue-v2
AZUREML_BATCH_ENVIRONMENT_NAME=poc07-batch-mlflow-py311

azure/batch/
  deploy_batch.py
  environment/conda.yaml
  code/batch_driver.py
  invoke_batch.py
```

- Keep local development on Poetry/Python 3.12, but use an explicit Python 3.11 Azure batch environment.
- Pin the remote runtime dependencies and include azureml-core required by the batch scoring runtime.
- Provide a custom batch_driver.py with init() and run(mini_batch) so Azure does not have to infer how to serve the logged model.
- Use a new deployment name blue-v2 to guarantee the endpoint invokes the corrected configuration.

Remote conda.yaml used by the corrected deployment

```
name: poc07-batch-mlflow-py311
channels:
  - conda-forge
dependencies:
  - python=3.11
  - pip<=24.3
  - pip:
    - mlflow==2.22.5
    - scikit-learn==1.7.2
    - pandas>=2.2,<3
    - numpy>=1.26,<3
    - azureml-core==1.61.0.post4
```

The serving environment is separate from the local Poetry environment. This is deliberate and avoids automatic image-generation incompatibilities.

batch_driver.py - explicit scoring contract

```
def init():
    # find MLmodel under AZUREML_MODEL_DIR
    # load registered model with mlflow.pyfunc.load_model(...)

def run(mini_batch):
    # read each CSV
    # select exactly the 8 FEATURES
    # model.predict(model_input)
    # return DataFrame with risk_score and is_delayed_pred
```

- The driver protects the model signature by selecting only the eight expected input features.
- It turns the model output into stable batch rows with risk_score and prediction class.
- This explicit scorer makes failures easier to diagnose than automatic MLflow serving inference.

invoke_batch.py - final safe input preparation

```
source = SCORING_DIR / "shipments_scoring.csv"
df = pd.read_csv(source)
batch_df = df[FEATURES].copy()

batch_dir = OUTPUT_DIR / "batch_input"
batch_df.to_csv(batch_dir / "shipments_batch.csv", index=False)

job = client.batch_endpoints.invoke(
    endpoint_name=endpoint_name,
    deployment_name=deployment_name,
    input=Input(type=AssetTypes.URI_FOLDER, path=batch_dir.resolve()),
)
```

The batch input folder is cleaned first so stale CSVs cannot be uploaded accidentally. shipment_id and is_delayed are excluded from the model feature matrix.

Corrected blue-v2 deployment succeeds

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python azure\batch\deploy_batch.py
=====
Azure ML Batch Deployment - custom runtime
=====
Model       : shipment-delay-model
Compute     : cpu-poc07 (Standard_DS2_v2)
Endpoint    : shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c
Deployment   : blue-v2
Environment : poc07-batch-mlflow-py311
Base image  : mcr.microsoft.com/azureml/openmpi4.1.0-ubuntu22.04:latest
Conda file  : C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\azure\batch\environment\conda.yaml
Score code  : C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\azure\batch\code\batch_driver.py
=====

[1/4] Creating/reusing scale-to-zero compute cpu-poc07
[OK] Compute ready

[2/4] Creating/reusing batch endpoint shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c
[OK] Endpoint ready

[3/4] Preparing explicit Python 3.11 batch environment
[OK] Using registered model: shipment-delay-model:1

[4/4] Creating/updating deployment blue-v2
Uploading code (0.01 MBs): 100%|#####| 9213/9213 [00:01<00:00, 7602.65it/s]

[OK] Deployment resource created/updated

[SUCCESS] Batch deployment is configured.
Endpoint   : shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c
Deployment  : blue-v2

IMPORTANT: the first invocation may still spend several minutes building
the custom environment image. In Studio, the BatchScoring node should no
longer use the previous auto-inferred environment.

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

```
poetry run python azure\batch\deploy_batch.py
```

- The deployment now creates an explicit environment and scoring script instead of relying on automatic image inference.
- The fresh deployment name prevents accidental reuse of the broken old blue deployment.

Verify the corrected deployment resource

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>az ml batch-deployment show ^
More? --name blue-v2 ^
More? --endpoint-name shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c ^
More? --resource-group rg-mlops-poc ^
More? --workspace-name aml-mlops-poc-ws ^
More? --query "{Name:name,ProvisioningState:provisioning_state,Compute:compute}" ^
More? -o table
Name      ProvisioningState      Compute
-----
blue-v2    Succeeded              azureml:/subscriptions/9902e04b-fd65-40f4-86a2-1b09c1fe672c/resourceGroups/rg-mlops-poc/providers/Microsoft.MachineLearningServices/workspaces/aml-mlops-poc-ws/computes/cpu-poc07

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

```
az ml batch-deployment show ^
--name blue-v2 ^
--endpoint-name <your-endpoint-name> ^
--resource-group rg-mlops-poc ^
--workspace-name aml-mlops-poc-ws -o table
```

Verify endpoint default deployment points to blue-v2

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>az ml batch-deployment show ^
More? --name blue-v2 ^
More? --endpoint-name shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c ^
More? --resource-group rg-mlops-poc ^
More? --workspace-name aml-mlops-poc-ws ^
More? --query "{Name:name,ProvisioningState:provisioning_state,Compute:compute}" ^
More? -o table
Name      ProvisioningState      Compute
-----
blue-v2    Succeeded              azureml:/subscriptions/9902e04b-fd65-40f4-86a2-1b09c1fe672c/resourceGroups/rg-mlops-poc/providers/Microsoft.MachineLearningServices/workspaces/aml-mlops-poc-ws/computes/cpu-poc07

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>az ml batch-endpoint show ^
More? --name shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c ^
More? --resource-group rg-mlops-poc ^
More? --workspace-name aml-mlops-poc-ws ^
More? --query "{Endpoint:name,DefaultDeployment:defaults.deployment_name}" ^
More? -o table
Endpoint      DefaultDeployment
-----
shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c  blue-v2
```

```
az ml batch-endpoint show ^
--name <your-endpoint-name> ^
--resource-group rg-mlops-poc ^
--workspace-name aml-mlops-poc-ws ^
--query "{Endpoint:name,DefaultDeployment:defaults.deployment_name}" -o table
```

Final invoke succeeds

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python azure\batch\invoke_batch.py
[OK] Prepared Azure batch input
File : C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\outputs\batch_input\shipments_batch.csv
Rows : 40
Columns: ['origin_region', 'destination_region', 'carrier', 'distance_km', 'order_hour', 'weekday', 'priority', 'historical_delay_rate']

=====
Azure ML Batch Invocation
=====
Endpoint : shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c
Deployment : blue-v2
Input : C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\outputs\batch_input
=====

[OK] Batch job submitted: batchjob-9604f003-7699-45b7-9b77-fec7453e1e95
[INFO] Waiting for Azure batch scoring...
RunId: batchjob-9604f003-7699-45b7-9b77-fec7453e1e95
Web View: https://ml.azure.com/runs/batchjob-9604f003-7699-45b7-9b77-fec7453e1e95?wsid=/subscriptions/9902e04b-fd65-40f4-86a2-1b09c1fe672c/resourcegroups/rg-mlops-poc/workspaces/aml-mlops-poc-ws

Streaming logs/azureml/executionlogs.txt
=====

[2026-09-06 14:12:00Z] Submitting 1 runs, first five are: d86cb356:ae3d19f5-2f99-4eda-b725-b477a2e78d2c
[2026-09-06 14:20:14Z] Completing processing run id ae3d19f5-2f99-4eda-b725-b477a2e78d2c.

Execution Summary
=====
RunId: batchjob-9604f003-7699-45b7-9b77-fec7453e1e95
Web View: https://ml.azure.com/runs/batchjob-9604f003-7699-45b7-9b77-fec7453e1e95?wsid=/subscriptions/9902e04b-fd65-40f4-86a2-1b09c1fe672c/resourcegroups/rg-mlops-poc/workspaces/aml-mlops-poc-ws

Downloading artifact azureml://datastores/workspaceblobstore/paths/azureml/ae3d19f5-2f99-4eda-b725-b477a2e78d2c/score/ to C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\outputs\batch_download

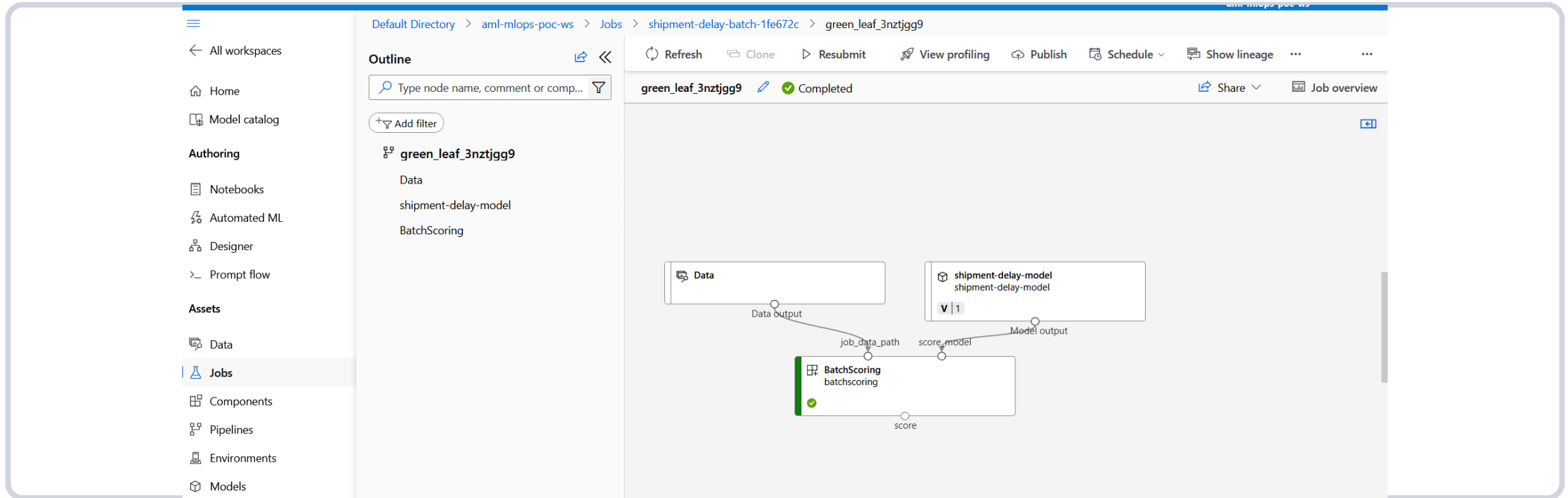
[SUCCESS] Azure batch scoring completed.
[OK] Batch output downloaded under: C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT\outputs\batch_download

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

```
poetry run python azure\batch\invoke_batch.py
```

- Input is uploaded, the Azure child scoring job runs successfully, and predictions are downloaded.
- This satisfies the source POC requirement that one cloud scoring path works.

Azure ML Studio shows the completed batch scoring job



- The BatchScoring node is green/completed rather than failed.
- This is the final visual proof that the corrected serving image, model, input and scoring code work together.

Cleanup immediately after validation

```
(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>poetry run python azure\batch\cleanup_batch.py
[DELETE] Batch endpoint: shipment-delay-batch-1fe672c
.....[DELETE] Compute: cpu-poc07
[OK] Batch serving resources deleted. Registered model/data/workspace remain.

(poc-07-azure-ml-mlflow-llmops-py3.12) C:\Users\ermdi\projects\ird-projects\de-ds-ai-automation\azure\POC_07_AZURE_ML_MLFLOW_LLMOPS_PROJECT>
```

```
poetry run python azure\batch\cleanup_batch.py
```

- Delete the temporary batch endpoint and AML compute after collecting evidence/screenshots.
- For a full teardown, delete model/data assets you do not need, then delete the entire POC resource group.
- Keep only the source repo, screenshots, result evidence and documentation needed for future reference.

Complete command sequence - local to Azure

```
poetry env use 3.12
poetry install
poetry run python -m ml.generate_data
poetry run python -m ml.train --tracking local
poetry run python -m ml.compare_runs
poetry run python -m ml.score --tracking local
poetry run python -m ml.verify_poc --tracking local
poetry run pytest -q
```

```
az login
az account set --subscription "Azure subscription 1"
poetry run python -m ml.verify_config
poetry run python -m ml.register_data
poetry run python -m ml.train --tracking azure
poetry run python -m ml.compare_runs
poetry run python -m ml.register_model --tracking azure
poetry run python -m ml.score --tracking azure
poetry run python -m ml.verify_poc --tracking azure --check-registry
```

Complete command sequence - batch serving

```
# .env must point to fresh corrected deployment
AZUREML_BATCH_DEPLOYMENT_NAME=blue-v2
AZUREML_BATCH_ENVIRONMENT_NAME=poc07-batch-mlflow-py311

poetry run python azure\batch\deploy_batch.py

az ml batch-deployment show ^
  --name blue-v2 ^
  --endpoint-name <your-endpoint-name> ^
  --resource-group rg-mlops-poc ^
  --workspace-name aml-mlops-poc-ws -o table

poetry run python azure\batch\invoke_batch.py
poetry run python azure\batch\cleanup_batch.py
```

Never continue invoking a known-broken deployment. Verify the deployment name in .env and in the Azure job metadata before debugging anything else.

Troubleshooting matrix - problems encountered in this POC

verify_config opens browser then fails	Credential path mismatch	Set AZURE_AUTH_MODE=cli; use AzureCliCredential
.env edits appear ignored	Existing process env overrides file	load_dotenv(..., override=True)
Workspace not found in Python	Wrong effective subscription/RG/workspace	Print effective values; verify with az ml workspace show
Parent batch job fails	Child BatchScoring failed	Inspect child job; parent exception is not root cause
Image build failed	Serving environment could not build	Use explicit Python 3.11 conda environment + custom sc
New invoke still uses old settings	Old deployment blue is still selected	Use fresh blue-v2 and verify endpoint default
Batch input schema mismatch	Extra/missing model columns	Create clean folder with exactly 8 FEATURES
Compute/quota issue	VM cannot allocate	Choose an allowed small CPU SKU, keep scale-to-zero

Monitoring and reproducibility checklist

- Scoring latency: batch job duration, startup time and mini-batch processing time.
- Errors: failed child jobs, model load errors, schema failures, storage access errors.
- Prediction distribution: monitor shifts in average risk_score and delayed-class rate.
- Feature drift: compare recent origin/destination/carrier/distance/hour/weekday/priority/history distributions with training data.
- Data freshness: prove that the scoring dataset is recent enough for the business decision.
- Reproducibility: a clean clone should be able to poetry install, generate data, train, track, register and score with the same class of results.
- CI concept: run deterministic generation + tests + local training checks before allowing cloud deployment changes.

Interview revision - key questions from POC-07

Q1. MLflow tracking vs model registry?

Tracking stores runs, parameters, metrics and artifacts. Registry manages promoted/versioned model assets and lifecycle metadata.

Q2. Batch vs online inference?

Batch scores many records asynchronously and is cost-effective for scheduled/data-engineering workloads. Online serves low-latency request/response traffic.

Q3. What is data leakage?

Using information unavailable at prediction time, which makes validation unrealistically optimistic.

Q4. How do you version data and models?

Use Azure ML data/model asset versions plus dataset fingerprints, run IDs, metrics and code version metadata.

Q5. Model monitoring vs pipeline monitoring?

Model monitoring watches prediction quality/distribution/drift; pipeline monitoring watches orchestration, data movement, failures and freshness.

Q6. How does a Data Engineer support ML reproducibility?

Version data contracts, automate deterministic pipelines, capture lineage, enforce schemas, and provide repeatable environments/CI.

POC completion checklist

- ☑ Resource group and Azure ML workspace created and verified.
- ☑ Poetry environment installs successfully with Python 3.12 locally.
- ☑ Synthetic train/scoring datasets generated; feature leakage review documented.
- ☑ Two candidate models trained and compared.
- ☑ Azure MLflow experiment runs visible in workspace.
- ☑ Selected model registered with model version/metadata.
- ☑ risk_score generated successfully.
- ☑ Batch endpoint/deployment created using explicit custom serving environment.
- ☑ Batch invocation completed successfully in Azure ML Studio.
- ☑ Endpoint and compute deleted after the demo.
- ☑ Final repository + screenshots + this reference guide retained for repeatability.

Final beginner takeaway

- Build locally first, then add Azure tracking. This makes cloud errors much easier to isolate.
- Always print the effective configuration Python is actually using; do not assume editing `.env` changed the current process.
- When a batch parent job fails, investigate the failed child job and the first real error in its logs.
- A deployment resource can succeed while the serving image later fails to build. Treat image build, compute allocation, model load and scoring as separate stages.
- Use fresh deployment names during troubleshooting so you can prove Azure is executing the corrected configuration.
- Capture both failure and success screenshots. They are valuable evidence of how the POC was debugged and made production-minded.
- Clean up temporary compute/endpoints immediately after the final validation.

Successful end state: Azure ML tracks two experiments, the selected model is registered, `risk_score` is produced, the corrected blue-v2 batch job completes, and temporary resources are cleaned up.